

Software Modernization Strategies

Workshop Edition

For each strategy, jot down your ideas, examples, or next steps in the empty field next to it.

 Ignore It! Leave your system alone as long as it does its job well.	Ignore It!	 Keep It Alive! Keep your legacy system running, but make it a conscious choice, not a habit.	Keep It Alive!	 Delegate! Hand off what is holding you back and focus on what actually matters.	Delegate!	 Give It Away! Open-source what you can no longer advance alone, and let the community share the load.	Give It Away!
 Sell It! Sell your legacy system to someone for whom it is worth more than it is to you.	Sell It!	 Buy New! Buy a ready-made solution when someone else has already solved your problem.	Buy New!	 Shut It Down! End your legacy system's operation in a planned, orderly, and drama-free way.	Shut It Down!	 Consolidate It! Replace your zoo of systems with fewer, more manageable units.	Consolidate It!
 Standardize It! Define how your systems are built, connected, and operated, and end the chaos.	Standardize It!	 Harmonize It! Align your systems, models, and processes so they work together without friction.	Harmonize It!	 Partner It! Work with external partners to evolve your system together.	Partner It!	 Bring It Back! Take back control of your system when outsourcing costs more than it delivers.	Bring It Back!
 Rethink It! Do not question your system, question the assumptions it was built on.	Rethink It!	 Remodel It! Align your system's structure with the domain as you understand it today.	Remodel It!	 Trim it down! Remove what nobody needs anymore and give your system its actual purpose back.	Trim it down!	 Improve It! Keep your system fit through continuous, unspectacular work before the debt catches up with you.	Improve It!
 Convert it! Keep your system's proven logic and only swap out the technology it lives in.	Convert it!	 Fork It! Split off part of your system and turn it into a standalone, independent solution.	Fork It!	 Repurpose It! Deploy your system for a new audience instead of maintaining it for a shrinking market.	Repurpose It!	 Salvage It! Keep the valuable components of your legacy system and leave the rest behind.	Salvage It!
 Wrap it! Leave the core untouched and only modernize how your system talks to the outside world.	Wrap it!	 Replace it! Build new when the old system is more burden than value.	Replace it!	 Divide It! Cut your system along its natural boundaries so one change no longer puts the whole system at risk.	Divide It!	 Extract! Pull the knowledge out of your system before you take the next step.	Extract!
 Preserve it! Preserve your system so you can still start it when needed, without actively maintaining it.	Preserve it!	 Replatform it! Give your system a new foundation when the code is still good but what is underneath no longer is.	Replatform it!	 Rehost it! Move your system to a new environment and leave everything else as it is.	Rehost it!	 Upgrade Tools! Bring your tooling up to date so legacy work becomes more efficient.	Upgrade Tools!
 Align Strategy! Align your organization's strategic direction toward a realistic approach to legacy.	Align Strategy!	 Reshape Org! Reshape teams, responsibilities, and incentives so legacy work finally works well.	Reshape Org!	 Upskill People! Invest in the people you already have before investing in new technology.	Upskill People!	 Improve Processes! Improve not the system, but the way your team works with it.	Improve Processes!

Strategy Categories:

Business (14) Development (10) Infrastructure (3) Enablement (5)